

Buying & Grading Plantain

Buy good quality · Pay fairly · Record accurately · Handle carefully



1 ACCEPTABLE PLANTAIN

Only buy plantain that meets **every** quality check below.

- ✓ Mature but not overripe — firm, angular fingers
- ✓ Freshly harvested — same day or within 24 hours
- ✓ Clean and free from dirt or latex staining
- ✓ Free from pests and disease damage (no sigatoka, weevil, crown rot)
- ✓ Fingers well formed and of normal shape for the variety
- ✓ Bunch well filled — no missing hands, all fingers present
- ✓ Cut stalk clean — not torn, crushed, or split



2 UNACCEPTABLE — DO NOT BUY



Overripe
yellow or black skin



Sigatoka / leaf spot
dark leaf lesions



Weevil damage
tunnels in corm/crown



Flower thrips / scarring
scabs, surface marks



Crown rot / soft stalk
mouldy or split base



Bunchy top / malformed
deformed fingers, gaps

⚠ Reject professionally: **reject the bunch, not the outgrower**. Document on the form, explain why, and offer the next-lower grade if it qualifies.

3 GRADING STANDARDS — BY VARIETY

Grade is set by **bunch weight + finger length + fill + defects**. All three varieties (FH / TH / RH) follow the same A/B/C/Reject logic, but with different kg thresholds. Use the **variety-specific numbers below**.

	GRADE A · PREMIUM	GRADE B · STANDARD	GRADE C · LOWER ACCEPTABLE	REJECT
Appearance	 Well-filled, uniform	 Slightly uneven	 Irregular, small	 Severe damage
False Horn (Musa AAB)	≥ 20 kg finger ≥ 20 cm	12–20 kg finger 15–20 cm	< 12 kg finger < 15 cm	Disease · pest · stage 3+ · severe damage
True Horn (Musa AAB)	≥ 12 kg finger ≥ 25 cm	8–12 kg finger 20–25 cm	< 8 kg finger < 20 cm	Disease · pest · stage 3+ · severe damage
Rhino Horn (Musa AAB)	≥ 25 kg finger ≥ 30 cm	15–25 kg finger 25–30 cm	< 15 kg finger < 25 cm	Disease · pest · stage 3+ · severe damage
Acceptable defects	None or very minor superficial marks	Minor superficial marks / scratches	Minor to moderate blemishes	Severe defects — not acceptable



False Horn
0% — baseline price
most common cooking plantain



True Horn
+5% to +10%
larger fingers, urban wholesale



Rhino Horn
+15% to +25%
premium restaurant & export

4 · ASSESS

- 1 Look at the whole bunch — fill & uniformity
- 2 Check finger size and shape against variety
- 3 Inspect for defects, pests or disease
- 4 Press gently — fingers should be firm, not soft
- 5 Check the cut — clean stalk, not torn or split

5 · WEIGH

- ⚖ **Calibrated scale only.** Tare (zero) before each bunch.
- 📏 Record **net kg** to one decimal (e.g. 25.4 kg).
- ⚠ **Shrinkage flag:** if net < farm weight by > 5%, flag for review.
- 📏 Weigh at the farm — not at the collection point.

6 · RECORD

- 📅 **Date** · **Outgrower ID**
- 📍 **Location / farm**
- 📊 **Grade** A · B · C · Reject
- ⚖ **Quantity** (kg) · **Price/kg**
- 📝 **Total paid** · **FO signature**
- 📷 Photo of bunch + signed receipt

7 · HANDLE & TRANSPORT

- 📦 **Handle with care.** Avoid throwing.
- 📦 **No heavy loads** stacked on plantain.
- 📦 **Clean, ventilated** transport vehicle.
- ☂ Protect from **sun & rain**.
- 📦 **Deliver ASAP** to collection point.



Good quality today, better returns tomorrow.

Thank the farmer · encourage good practices · build long-term relationships.